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Good Thing, Bad Thing, Who Knows? 🤔

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Hello Curious Minds,

Life has a way of surprising us. Something that seems like a bad today might turn into a blessing tomorrow. Or what feels like a big win could come with unexpected challenges? Lets dive in, first with a story and than reflections:

There's an old story about a Chinese farmer.

*One day, his **horse ran away**. The villagers said, "Such bad luck!" The farmer replied, "**Good thing, bad thing, who knows?**"*

*A few days later, the horse returned—**bringing more horses**. The villagers cheered, "What great fortune!" The farmer? "**Good thing, bad thing, who knows?**"*

*While taming one of the new horses, his **son fell and broke his leg**. The villagers were upset, "Such terrible misfortune!" The farmer? "**Good thing, bad thing, who knows?**"*

*Soon after, the **army came to recruit young men for war**, but the injured son was spared. The villagers called it a blessing. The farmer? You*

guessed it—"Good thing, bad thing, who knows?"

Reflections of my own journey

🔥 **Setback: Failed in the 12th Grade** I didn't get the grades I wanted. It felt like a failure, like my path was closing. I was disappointed. My dad simply said, "Good thing, bad thing, who knows?"

🚀 **Rejoice: Found My Calling** That setback made me push harder. I got into engineering at [Atmiya Institute of Technology & Science](#), won over 10 awards, president of association, landed a top tier company offer right from campus, won awards, and even got an investor for our dream project. Things were looking up. I said, "Good thing, bad thing, who knows?"

⚡ **Setback: Offer Delayed Due to Recession** The 2008 recession hit, and my job offer was put on hold. It felt like another delay. But my brother, [Rohit Surani](#), reminded me: "Good thing, bad thing, who knows?"

🌟 **Rejoice: A Different Path Opened** Instead, I joined [Nielsen](#), then pursued an MBA at [Ahmedabad University](#)—opportunities I wouldn't have considered otherwise. By the time finally called, I had already moved forward.

In Global Consulting from last 14 years now! [Mastek](#)

The Lesson? Life Has Its Own Plan.

We judge moments too soon. But what if we simply **paused** and allowed life to unfold?

- 💠 **Missed an opportunity?** Maybe something better is coming.
- 💠 **Facing a setback?** Maybe it's setting you up for a breakthrough.
- 💠 **Feeling stuck?** Maybe you're exactly where you need to be.

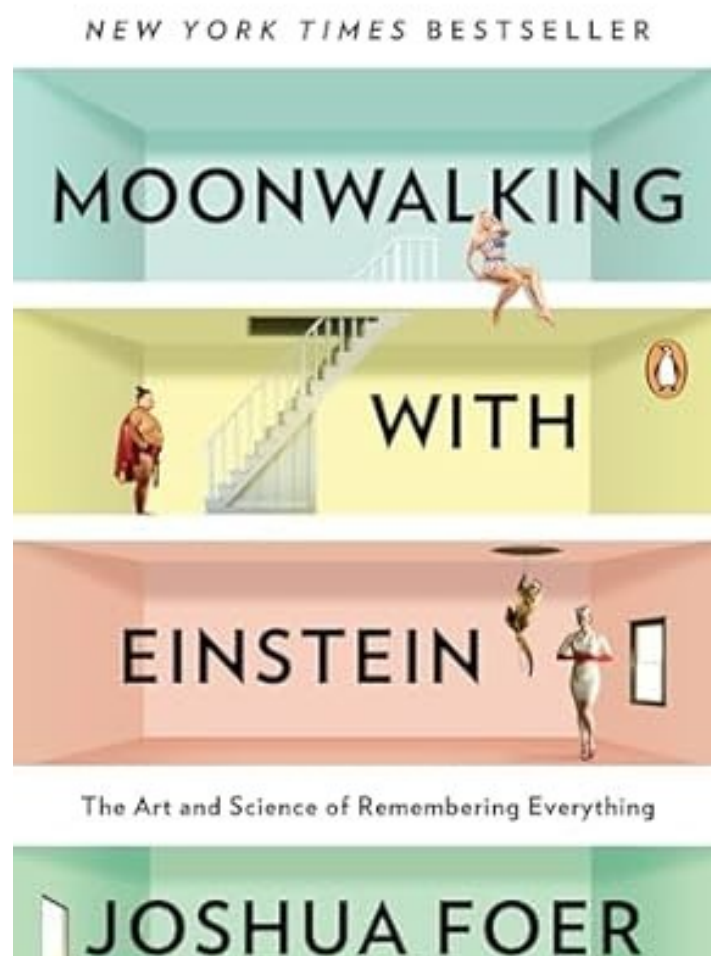
So next time life throws a curveball, take a deep breath and say:

"Good thing, bad thing, who knows?"

Now, I'd love to hear from you—what's something that felt "bad" at first but turned out to be a blessing? Drop your thoughts!

Until next time, **Vikas Surani**

P.S. **Giveaway Alert!** This week's **Being Curious** book giveaway goes to subscriber [Saumendra Rathod](#)—someone who speaks his mind, even when it's contrarian. A rare trait that sparks great conversations! 🚀
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Being Curious: Saumendra x Vikas

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10mo ...

Thanks for sharing your story. It's something to remember.

And incidentally the book you chose is also going to be something that helps people remember :) Kudos :)

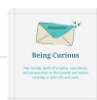
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**Vikas Surani**  Author
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10mo ...

[NiyamSan Chhaya](#) Indeed!

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Being Curious

A weekly newsletter where I share quick insights, experiences, and lessons learned from my journey.



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